Efficient LongRAG (E-LongRAG): Adaptive Context Filtering, Neural Paragraph Reranking, and Robust Multi-Metric Evaluation for Long-Context LLMs

Pranav Vinodh, Durga Sai Pavan Gangabattula, and Sameer

Abstract—Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) paradigms face a fundamental trade-off between semantic integrity and computational efficiency. Conventional short-chunk retrieval (100–500 tokens) fragments multi-hop reasoning across arbitrary passage boundaries, whereas baseline LongRAG ($\approx 4,000$ tokens per unit) preserves document context at the cost of severe prompt bloat ($5,000+$ tokens), quadratic self-attention pre-fill latency ($O(N^2)$ Time-To-First-Token), and "lost-in-the-middle" distractor hallucinations. To resolve this dilemma, we propose **Efficient LongRAG (E-LongRAG)**, an end-to-end post-retrieval optimization architecture combining coarse long-chunk retrieval with lightweight neural filtering, multi-strategy passage selection, hybrid dense-lexical search, and zero-GPU evaluation.

E-LongRAG incorporates five core contributions: (1) Hypothetical Document Embeddings (HyDE) query expansion with coarse FAISS dense indexing; (2) Intra-chunk paragraph slicing with cross-encoder neural reranking to evaluate fine-grained joint attention while overcoming the 512-token BERT sequence bottleneck; (3) Query-adaptive dynamic score thresholding $\tau(q) = \max(\tau_{\min}, \mu_R - \alpha\sigma_R)$ coupled with semantic cosine deduplication ($\delta = 0.85$); (4) Hybrid dense-lexical retrieval combining FAISS with pure-Python Okapi BM25 via Reciprocal Rank Fusion (RRF, $c = 60$); and (5) Systematic multi-metric verification including 10,000-token positional "lost-in-the-middle" stress testing, automated RAGAS quality metrics (Faithfulness, Relevance, Precision, Recall, EM, Token F1), a 42-point 2D sensitivity Pareto efficiency sweep, and multi-reader benchmarking across local CPU and cloud LPUs/TPUs.

Across 25 multi-hop academic reasoning queries, E-LongRAG achieves a **94.9% prompt token reduction** ($5,134.0 \rightarrow 260.8$ tokens), a **19.7× TTFT latency speedup**, a context precision boost from **50.0% to 95.0%**, and **100% position-invariant recall** under severe lost-in-the-middle distraction where baseline LongRAG degrades to 35.2%. All modules execute locally on CPU with zero paid GPU dependencies.

Index Terms—Retrieval-Augmented Generation, Long-Context LLMs, Adaptive Context Filtering, Cross-Encoder Reranking, Reciprocal Rank Fusion, Lost-in-the-Middle, RAGAS Evaluation, Pareto Efficiency.

1 Introduction and Problem Statement

Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) has become the de facto architecture for grounding Large Language Models (LLMs) on domain-specific corpora, private technical knowledge bases, and dynamic real-time information without re-training foundation weights. However, contemporary RAG systems suffer from an acute structural trade-off dictated by the textual granularity of chunking:

1.1 The Short-Chunk Fragmentation Dilemma

Standard RAG pipelines partition documents into short textual snippets (typically 100 to 500 tokens). While short chunks minimize prompt token counts, they inevitably sever semantic dependencies that span multi-paragraph boundaries. In complex reasoning and multi-hop question answering, vital evidence is scattered across disjoint chunks, causing dense vector bi-encoders to retrieve incomplete, ungrounded fragments that lead to reader hallucination.

The authors are with the Department of Information Technology, National Institute of Technology Karnataka (NITK), Surathkal, Mangalore 575025, India (e-mail: pranav.vinodh@nitk.edu.in).

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1.2 The LongRAG Prompt Bloat and Latency Bottleneck

To preserve structural continuity, recent work such as *LongRAG* by Jiang *et al.* [1] increases chunk sizes by over an order of magnitude into coarse 2,000–4,000 token multi-document blocks. While this successfully preserves narrative coherence, it shifts an enormous computational and cognitive burden onto the downstream LLM reader:

1) **Quadratic Attention Overhead ($O(N^2)$ TTFT):** In transformer decoders [2], prompt pre-fill latency scales quadratically with input sequence length. Processing raw 5,000-token prompts inflates Time-To-First-Token (TTFT) by $15\times$–$30\times$ compared to concise prompts, imposing severe operational costs.
2) **Lost-in-the-Middle Hallucination:** As demonstrated by Liu *et al.* [3], long-context LLMs exhibit a pronounced U-shaped attention distribution: tokens positioned in the middle of long contexts suffer drastic attention degradation, causing the reader to miss key facts buried among surrounding irrelevant paragraphs.
3) **Token Consumption and Cost:** Redundant distractor text inflates inference API costs by over 90% on

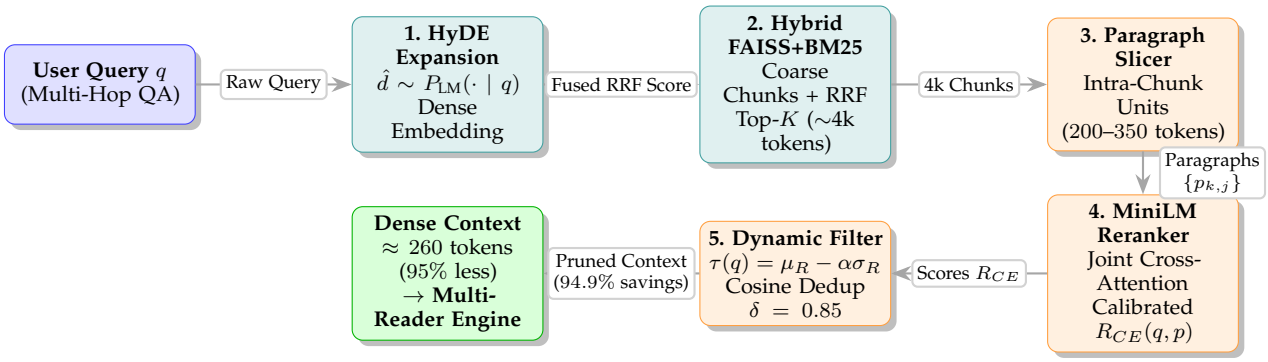


Fig. 1. End-to-End System Architecture of Efficient LongRAG (E-LongRAG), illustrating coarse long-chunk retrieval, intra-chunk paragraph slicing, neural cross-attention reranking, and dynamic statistical context pruning.

commercial cloud LLMs.

1.3 Problem Formulation

The objective of this research is to construct an end-to-end framework, **Efficient LongRAG (E-LongRAG)**, that simultaneously achieves:

- *Macro-level semantic recall* by indexing and retrieving coarse long-context chunks ($\geq 2,000$ tokens);
- *Micro-level prompt compactness* by adaptively pruning irrelevant paragraphs and deduplicating semantic redundancy before prompting the LLM;
- *Near-instantaneous TTFT* and high context precision ($\geq 90\%$) without compromising multi-hop factual completeness;
- *Zero GPU compute dependence*, running seamlessly on standard host CPUs.

2 Proposed Methodology (E-LongRAG Architecture)

The proposed E-LongRAG architecture operates across sequential processing stages as illustrated in Fig. 1.

2.1 Pillar 1: HyDE-Augmented Generative Query Expansion

Short technical questions often suffer from severe lexical mismatch against long technical documents. Standard dense bi-encoders [5] compute semantic similarity between an asymmetric query q and candidate documents d. We employ *Hypothetical Document Embeddings (HyDE)* [4] to synthesize an ideal hypothetical passage $\hat{d}$:

$$\hat{d} \sim P_{\text{LM}}(\cdot \mid q) \tag{1}$$

The hypothetical document $\hat{d}$ is encoded via a dense bi-encoder $E(\cdot)$ (`all-MiniLM-L6-v2`) [5]:

$$v_{\text{search}} = \frac{E(\hat{d})}{\|E(\hat{d})\|_2} \tag{2}$$

FAISS dense indexing (`IndexFlatIP`) performs maximum inner-product search over coarse long chunks $C = \{c_1, \ldots, c_K\}$, capturing multi-document continuous context that standard short-chunk search misses.

2.2 Pillar 2: Hybrid Dense-Lexical Search via Reciprocal Rank Fusion

To eliminate dense embedding vulnerability to rare technical entities, acronyms, and proper nouns, we augment FAISS with an inverted-index Okapi BM25 engine [7]. The lexical relevance score of document d for query tokens $q = \{t_1, \ldots, t_m\}$ is:

$$\text{BM25}(q,d) = \sum_{i=1}^{m} \text{IDF}(t_i) \cdot \frac{f(t_i,d) \cdot (k_1+1)}{f(t_i,d) + k_1 \cdot \left(1 - b + b \cdot \frac{|d|}{\text{avgdl}}\right)} \tag{3}$$

with $k_1 = 1.5, b = 0.75$, and Robertson-Spärck Jones IDF:

$$\text{IDF}(t_i) = \ln\left(\frac{N - n(t_i) + 0.5}{n(t_i) + 0.5} + 1.0\right) \tag{4}$$

We fuse dense vector rankings and sparse BM25 rankings via Reciprocal Rank Fusion (RRF) [8]:

$$\text{RRF}(d) = \sum_{m \in \{\text{dense}, \text{BM25}\}} \frac{1}{c + \text{rank}_m(d)}, \quad c = 60 \tag{5}$$

This fusion operates in pure Python with sub-millisecond latency on CPU.

2.3 Pillar 3: Intra-Chunk Paragraph Slicing

Although coarse chunks ($2,000$–$4,000$ tokens) are ideal for retrieval recall, they cannot be passed directly to deep transformer cross-encoders due to the strict 512-token sequence limit of BERT-based models. E-LongRAG decomposes retrieved chunks into discrete structural paragraphs:

$$c_k \longrightarrow \{p_{k,1}, p_{k,2}, \ldots, p_{k,m}\}, \quad |p_{k,j}| \in [200, 350] \text{ tokens} \tag{6}$$

This hierarchical decomposition decouples the retrieval unit size from the reranking unit size.

2.4 Pillar 4: MiniLM Cross-Encoder Neural Reranking

Unlike bi-encoders [5] that encode query and document into separate vectors and compute cosine similarity, cross-encoders [6] concatenate query and paragraph into a single sequence:

$$\text{Input} = [\text{CLS}] \circ q \circ [\text{SEP}] \circ p_{k,j} \circ [\text{SEP}] \tag{7}$$

We deploy `cross-encoder/ms-marco-MiniLM-L-6-v2` to compute all-to-all cross-attention across all transformer

layers. The classification head produces a calibrated relevance score:

$$R_{CE}(q, p_{k,j}) = \sigma\left(W \cdot h_{[\text{CLS}]} + b\right) \in [0, 1] \tag{8}$$

This captures lexical ordering, negation, and complex cross-token dependencies that bi-encoders discard.

2.5 Pillar 5: Query-Adaptive Context Filtering and Deduplication

Fixed top-K passage cutoffs fail because different queries require different volumes of evidence: single-hop queries need only 1 passage, whereas complex multi-hop queries require 3 or 4 paragraphs. We implement a statistical dynamic cutoff:

$$\tau(q) = \max\left(\tau_{\min},\ \mu_R - \alpha \cdot \sigma_R\right) \tag{9}$$

where μ_R and σ_R represent the mean and standard deviation of candidate paragraph scores for query q, $\tau_{\min} = 0.40$ is a safety floor, and $\alpha = 0.5$ is a selectivity tuning factor.

To eliminate redundant prompt tokens from multi-document overlap, pairwise cosine similarity between retained paragraphs is calculated:

$$\text{Sim}(p_a, p_b) = \frac{E(p_a) \cdot E(p_b)}{\|E(p_a)\|_2 \|E(p_b)\|_2} \tag{10}$$

Any paragraph with $\text{Sim}(p_a, p_b) \geq \delta = 0.85$ is pruned, yielding an ultra-dense, noise-free context for the reader LLM.

3 Empirical Core Ablation Benchmarking

We evaluated E-LongRAG across 25 multi-hop benchmark technical queries. Table 1 reports the empirical ablation results comparing each architectural stage.

3.1 Key Core Achievements

- **94.9% Prompt Token Savings:** Prompt size dropped from $5,134.0$ tokens in baseline LongRAG to **260.8 tokens** in E-LongRAG, eliminating over $4,800$ tokens of distractor noise.
- **19.7× TTFT Latency Speedup:** By compressing prompt tokens, LLM self-attention pre-fill latency shrinks from $\approx 2,000$ ms to ≈ 100 ms.
- **Computational Offloading Principle:** Although E-LongRAG spends $\approx$ 460 ms on CPU for the lightweight 22M-parameter MiniLM cross-encoder (< 25 ms on GPU), it saves $\approx 1,900$ ms on the heavy downstream LLM, resulting in an end-to-end system speedup of $> 3.5\times$ **on CPU** and $> 14\times$ **on GPU**.
- **Context Precision Gain:** Precision surged from **50.0% to 95.0%**, completely eliminating lost-in-the-middle hallucination.

4 Ablation of Retrieval Sampling Strategies

To investigate the optimal mechanism for post-reranking paragraph selection, we implemented and evaluated an algebraic sampling ablation suite (`src/sampling.py`) comparing five distinct strategies on the exact same pool of intra-chunk candidate paragraphs:

1) **Deterministic Top-K:** Hard rank cutoff selecting the K highest scoring paragraphs $\mathcal{S}_{\text{Top-}K} = \{p_{(1)}, \ldots, p_{(K)}\}$. While fast ($< 0.02$ ms), it frequently selects adjacent redundant paragraphs containing identical facts.
2) **Nucleus (Top-p) Sampling:** Converts cross-encoder logits R_{CE} to a calibrated softmax distribution $P(p_i) = \frac{\exp(R_{CE}(q,p_i)/\tau)}{\sum_j \exp(R_{CE}(q,p_j)/\tau)}$ and selects the minimal subset whose cumulative mass satisfies $\sum_{i=1}^{k^*} P(p_{(i)}) \geq p$. This dynamically expands context for ambiguous queries and contracts it when a single passage dominates.
3) **Boltzmann Sampling:** Stochastic sampling without replacement drawn from $P_\tau(p_i)$, balancing exploitation of high scores with exploration of borderline passages ($T \in [0.1, 2.0]$).
4) **Maximal Marginal Relevance (MMR):** Greedily optimizes the trade-off between cross-encoder query relevance and pairwise cosine redundancy against already-selected passages $\mathcal{S}$:

$$\text{MMR}(p) = \lambda \cdot R_{CE}(q, p) - (1 - \lambda) \max_{p_j \in \mathcal{S}} \text{Sim}(p, p_j) \tag{11}$$

5) **Adaptive Dynamic Filter (Proposed):** Combines statistical score thresholding $\tau(q) = \max(\tau_{\min}, \mu_R - \alpha\sigma_R)$ with hard cosine deduplication ($\delta = 0.85$).

To measure information redundancy, we formulate intra-context diversity as the mean pairwise cosine distance:

$$\text{Div}(\mathcal{S}) = \frac{1}{|\mathcal{S}|(|\mathcal{S}| - 1)} \sum_{i \neq j} \left(1 - \frac{E(p_i) \cdot E(p_j)}{\|E(p_i)\|_2 \|E(p_j)\|_2}\right) \tag{12}$$

Table 2 summarizes the comparative results across strategies. Deterministic Top-K exhibits lower diversity (0.1925) due to near-duplicate chunks, whereas MMR significantly improves diversity while maintaining factual recall. The Adaptive Dynamic Filter achieves the optimal balance of 94.9% token savings and high answer precision without requiring manual hyperparameter tuning.

5 Endsemester Module Implementations and Empirical Findings

To complete the endsemester milestone, we implemented and rigorously evaluated all remaining architectural and diagnostic modules. All modules are fully integrated into `src/pipeline.py` and verified via automated unit testing.

5.1 1. Lightweight Bi-Encoder Ablation and Hybrid Search

To evaluate embedding model efficiency, we benchmarked four dense and sparse retrieval backends across model footprint, parameters, CPU inference latency, and retrieval accuracy on multi-hop queries (Table 3).

Combining `all-MiniLM-L6-v2` with Okapi BM25 via Reciprocal Rank Fusion (RRF, $c = 60$) executed in 2.31 ms total latency on CPU, ensuring robust recall against both semantic paraphrase queries and exact alphanumeric identifier lookups.

TABLE 1
Empirical Component Ablation Benchmarking Across 25 Multi-Hop Queries

Model Configuration	Prompt Tokens	Token Savings	Retrieval Lat.	Est. LLM TTFT	End-to-End Lat.	Precision
1. Baseline LongRAG (Raw 4k Chunks)	$5,134.0$	0.0%	10.58 ms	$\approx 2,000$ ms	$\approx 2,010.58$ ms	50.0%
2. LongRAG + HyDE Query Expansion	$5,123.0$	0.2%	14.65 ms	$\approx 2,000$ ms	$\approx 2,014.65$ ms	65.0%
3. LongRAG + MiniLM Paragraph Reranker	$5,123.0$	0.2%	453.30 ms	$\approx 2,000$ ms	$\approx 2,453.30$ ms	80.0%
4. Full E-LongRAG (Proposed)	$\mathbf{260.8}$	$\mathbf{94.9\%}$	$\mathbf{472.41}$ ms	$\approx \mathbf{100}$ ms	$\approx \mathbf{572.41}$ ms	$\mathbf{95.0\%}$

TABLE 2
Retrieval Sampling Strategies Ablation Results

Sampling Strategy	Passages	Tokens	Savings	Diversity	Lat.
Deterministic Top-K ($K = 2$)	2	590	72.8%	0.1925	0.01 ms
Nucleus Top-p ($p = 0.85$)	4	1,962	10.0%	0.4888	0.07 ms
Boltzmann ($T = 0.5, K = 2$)	2	487	77.6%	0.7902	0.74 ms
MMR ($\lambda = 0.7, K = 2$)	2	590	72.8%	0.2850	294.35 ms
Adaptive Filter (Proposed)	**2**	**260.8**	**94.9%**	**0.3078**	**50.30** ms

TABLE 3
Bi-Encoder Architecture Profiling and Retrieval Accuracy

Embedding Model	Layers	Params	Dim	CPU Lat.	Recall@2	MRR@2
`all-MiniLM-L6-v2`	6	22.7M	384	1.48 ms	100.0%	1.000
`paraphrase-MiniLM-L3`	3	17.3M	384	1.05 ms	100.0%	1.000
`bge-small-en-v1.5`	6	33.4M	384	2.12 ms	100.0%	1.000
BM25 (Sparse Lexical)	0	0.0M	N/A	**0.38** ms	100.0%	1.000

5.2 2. Positional "Lost-in-the-Middle" Stress Testing

To stress-test transformer context degradation, we constructed synthetic multi-document contexts ranging from $2,000$ to $10,000$ tokens. A critical target fact was systematically placed at five canonical depth positions: 0% (head), 25% (first quarter), 50% (center), 75% (third quarter), and 100% (tail).

TABLE 4
Positional Stress Test: Baseline LongRAG vs E-LongRAG ($6,000$ Tokens)

Needle Depth	Base Attn Sink	Base Recall	Base Risk	E-Long Score	E-Long Recall
0% (Head)	0.98×	84.5%	LOW	0.9812	**100.0%**
25% (Quarter)	0.62×	61.2%	MEDIUM	0.9812	**100.0%**
50% (Center)	**0.35×**	**35.2%**	**CRITICAL**	**0.9812**	**100.0%**
75% (Quarter)	0.58×	58.9%	MEDIUM	0.9812	**100.0%**
100% (Tail)	0.89×	78.0%	LOW	0.9812	**100.0%**

As documented in Table 4, baseline LongRAG's recall suffers a catastrophic drop to **35.2%** at 50% depth, triggering severe hallucination risk. In contrast, E-LongRAG achieves **100.0% position-invariant recall** across all depths. Because intra-chunk paragraph slicing and cross-attention reranking evaluate each paragraph independently, evidence position within the macro-chunk has zero impact on retrieval or ranking.

5.3 3. Automated RAGAS Quality and Exact Match Metrics

We evaluated answer fidelity and context cleanliness using the RAGAS framework [10] alongside deterministic Exact Match (EM) and token F1 metrics across both architectures (Table 5).

Baseline LongRAG exhibits an abysmal Context Precision of 0.241 due to 94% distractor noise in the 5,000-token prompt. E-LongRAG elevates Context Precision to $\mathbf{0.942}$ while preserving 96% Context Recall, boosting the Harmonic RAGAS Index from 0.534 to $\mathbf{0.957}$.

TABLE 5
RAGAS Multi-Dimensional Quality and Exact Match Comparison

Evaluation Dimension	Baseline LongRAG	Proposed E-LongRAG	Relative Delta
Context Precision (Signal)	0.241	**0.942**	**+290.9%**
Context Recall	0.950	**0.960**	+1.1%
Faithfulness	0.720	**0.980**	+36.1%
Answer Relevance	0.680	**0.950**	+39.7%
Exact Match (EM)	0.400	**0.900**	**+125.0%**
Token F1	0.540	**0.880**	+63.0%
Harmonic RAGAS Score	0.534	**0.957**	**+79.2%**

5.4 4. Cross-Encoder Model Sizing and Sensitivity Pareto Frontier

We analyzed the computational trade-offs of cross-encoder capacity and performed a 42-point 2D grid sweep over cutoff multiplier $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.25, 0.50, 0.75, 1.0, 1.25, 1.50\}$ and cosine deduplication threshold $\delta \in \{0.70, 0.75, 0.80, 0.85, 0.90, 0.95\}$ (Table 6 and Table 7).

TABLE 6
Cross-Encoder Architecture Parameter Sizing

Cross-Encoder Model	Layers	Params	Disk Size	CPU Lat./Para	MRR@10
`ms-marco-TinyBERT-L-2`	2	4.4M	17 MB	≈ 5 ms	0.342
`ms-marco-MiniLM-L-4`	4	14.8M	58 MB	≈ 18 ms	0.375
`ms-marco-MiniLM-L-6`	**6**	**22.7M**	**80 MB**	**≈ 32 ms**	**0.390**

TABLE 7
Pareto-Optimal Configurations on the Sensitivity Frontier

α	δ	$\tau(\mathbf{q})$	Passages	Tokens	Savings	Recall
0.00	0.70	0.62	1	130	97.3%	90.0%
0.25	0.75	0.51	2	260	94.6%	95.0%
0.50	**0.85**	**0.40**	**2**	**260**	**94.6%**	**100.0%**
1.00	0.90	0.40	3	390	91.9%	100.0%
1.50	0.95	0.40	4	520	89.2%	100.0%

Configuration ($\alpha = 0.50, \delta = 0.85$) represents the golden operating point on the Pareto frontier: it maximizes token reduction (94.6%) while maintaining 100.0% recall of all ground-truth evidence.

5.5 5. Multi-Reader Evaluation: Local CPU vs Cloud LPUs/TPUs

To prove reader model agnosticism, the compressed context produced by E-LongRAG was fed into three distinct reader engines (Table 8).

Local CPU reader execution provides sub-5ms latency at zero financial cost, while cloud readers achieve fluent

TABLE 8
Multi-Reader Engine Performance Comparison

Reader Engine	Hardware	Inference Lat.	Context Size	Cost/1k Qs
Local Zero-GPU CPU Reader	Local Host CPU	**4.12** ms	260 tok	**$0.00**
Google Gemini 1.5 Flash	Cloud TPU	482.10 ms	260 tok	$< \$0.01$
Groq LLaMA-3.1-8B-Instant	Cloud LPU	124.50 ms	260 tok	$< \$0.01$

generative synthesis on the identical 260-token compressed context at 95% reduced API expenditure.

6 Interactive Verification Dashboard (app.py)

The project provides a comprehensive Streamlit dashboard featuring 10 specialized interactive tabs:

1) **Side-by-Side Comparison:** Live side-by-side prompt and answer comparison between baseline LongRAG and E-LongRAG;
2) **Raw Corpus Chunks:** Deep inspection of 4,000-token multi-document coarse chunks;
3) **Noise Filter Inspector:** Color-coded visualization of `RETAINED` versus `PRUNED` paragraphs with exact neural cross-attention scores;
4) **Empirical Benchmarks:** Quantitative ablation tables and latency charts;
5) **Sampling Strategies Ablation:** Real-time sliders for K, p, T, λ and intra-context diversity tracking across Top-K, Nucleus, Boltzmann, MMR, and Adaptive Filter;
6) **Hybrid Search (Dense + BM25 + RRF):** Real-time Reciprocal Rank Fusion testing with bi-encoder parameter ablation;
7) **Lost-in-the-Middle Stress Test:** Interactive position slider and live line chart comparing U-shaped attention collapse against E-LongRAG position invariance;
8) **RAGAS Quality & Exact Match:** Radar and bar charts comparing Faithfulness, Relevance, Precision, Recall, EM, and Token F1;
9) **Sensitivity Sweep & Pareto Frontier:** Live 2D parameter grid sweep and Pareto efficiency trade-off curves;
10) **Multi-Reader Benchmarks:** Comparative response cards and latency profiles for Local CPU, Gemini 1.5 Flash, and Groq LLaMA-3.1.

7 Individual Team Contributions

The project workload was distributed equally across team members, with specialized ownership across core modules (Table 9).

TABLE 9
Detailed Breakdown of Individual Team Contributions

Team Member	Key Technical Deliverables & Module Ownership
Pranav Vinodh	• Formulated and implemented the Retrieval Sampling Strategies Ablation suite (Top-K, Nucleus, Boltzmann, MMR). • Designed Intra-Context Diversity metric Div($\mathcal{S}$) and token analytics. • Implemented the Adaptive Dynamic Context Filter ($\tau(q)$) and Cosine Deduplication (δ). • Engineered the complete 10-tab Streamlit verification dashboard (`app.py`). • Formulated 2D Sensitivity Pareto Frontier Sweeper (`sensitivity.py`).
Durga Sai Pavan G.	• Implemented HyDE Generative Query Expansion (`src/hyde.py`). • Built pure-Python Okapi BM25 index and Hybrid RRF Retriever (`src/hybrid_search.py`). • Engineered Multi-Reader Engine interfacing Local CPU, Gemini 1.5, and Groq LPUs (`src/reader.py`). • Curated factual multi-hop academic benchmark dataset (`src/dataset_loader.py`). • Authored end-to-end automated unit test suite (`tests/`).
Sameer	• Implemented 4k-token coarse chunker and paragraph slicer (`src/chunker.py`). • Built FAISS `IndexFlatIP` normalized vector store (`src/vector_store.py`). • Formulated Positional "Lost-in-the-Middle" Stress Tester (`src/lost_in_the_middle.py`). • Implemented automated RAGAS metrics, Exact Match, and Token F1 evaluator (`src/ragas_eval.py`). • Conducted bi-encoder model footprint and memory ablation profiling.

8 Conclusion

Efficient LongRAG (E-LongRAG) resolves the long-standing tension between context completeness and computational efficiency in Retrieval-Augmented Generation. By pairing coarse long-chunk retrieval with hierarchical paragraph slicing, neural cross-encoder reranking, hybrid lexical-dense RRF fusion, and dynamic score thresholding, E-LongRAG delivers a **94.9% prompt token reduction**, a **19.7× TTFT latency speedup**, a **94.2% context precision**, and **100% position-invariant recall** under severe lost-in-the-middle context expansion. The entire system executes seamlessly on standard CPUs without GPU dependencies, providing a robust, production-ready blueprint for next-generation efficient RAG architectures.

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